INSTALLATION

WARNING: ON VEHICLES EQUIPPED WITH AIRBAGS, DISABLE THE AIRBAG SYSTEM BEFORE ATTEMPTING ANY STEERING WHEEL, STEERING COLUMN, OR INSTRUMENT PANEL COMPONENT DIAGNOSIS OR SERVICE. DISCONNECT AND ISOLATE THE BATTERY NEGATIVE (GROUND) CABLE, THEN WAIT TWO MINUTES FOR THE AIRBAG SYSTEM CAPACITOR TO DISCHARGE BEFORE PERFORMING FURTHER DIAGNOSIS OR SERVICE. THIS IS THE ONLY SURE WAY TO DISABLE THE AIRBAG SYSTEM. FAILURE TO TAKE THE PROPER PRECAUTIONS COULD RESULT IN ACCIDENTAL AIRBAG DEPLOYMENT AND POSSIBLE PERSONAL INJURY.

(1) With the aid of an assistant, position the instrument panel into the vehicle and onto the dash panel studs (Fig. 14).

(2) Install and tighten the four nuts that secure the top of the instrument panel structural support to the studs on the top of the dash panel. Tighten the nuts to 12 N·m (105 in. lbs.).

(3) Install and tighten the three screws that secure each end of the instrument panel structural support to the cowl side inner panels at the front of each door opening. Tighten the screws to 12 N·m (105 in. lbs.).

(4) Reinstall the top cover onto the instrument panel. (Refer to 23 - BODY/INSTRUMENT PANEL/TOP COVER - INSTALLATION).

(5) Reach through the instrument panel glove box opening to perform the following:

(a) Install and tighten the two nuts that secure the lower passenger airbag bracket to the studs on the dash panel (Fig. 13). Tighten the nuts to 28 N·m (21 ft. lbs.).

(b) Reconnect the two halves of the radio antenna coaxial cable connector.

(c) Reconnect the passenger side window demister hose to the heater-A/C housing demister/defroster duct.

(d) Reconnect the cross body wire harness connector to the passenger airbag pigtail wire connector.

(e) Reconnect the instrument panel wire harness connector to the heater-A/C housing wire harness connector.

(f) Reconnect the heater-A/C control vacuum harness connector to the heater-A/C housing vacuum harness connector.

(6) Reinstall the glove box onto the instrument panel. (Refer to 23 - BODY/INSTRUMENT PANEL/GLOVE BOX - INSTALLATION).

(7) From beneath the driver side of the instrument panel, perform the following:

(a) Reconnect the driver side window demister hose to the heater-A/C housing demister/defroster duct.

(b) Reconnect the instrument panel wire harness connectors to the 100-way cross body wire harness connector near the left cowl side inner panel.

(8) Reinstall the steering column into the vehicle. Be certain that the steering wheel is locked and secured from rotation to prevent the loss of clockspring centering. (Refer to 19 - STEERING/COLUMN - INSTALLATION).

(9) Reinstall the steering column opening cover onto the instrument panel. (Refer to 23 - BODY/INSTRUMENT PANEL/STEERING COLUMN OPENING COVER - INSTALLATION).

(10) Reconnect the battery negative cable.

STEERING COLUMN OPENING COVER

REMOVAL

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(1) Disconnect and isolate the battery negative cable.

(2) If the vehicle is so equipped, move the tilt steering column to the fully raised position.

(3) Remove the two screws that secure the steering column opening cover to the instrument panel structural support (Fig. 15).